

Aradhana Alpha vs Joyalukkas

A screen-by-screen design comparison of the v1.0 alpha against the app it's modelled on — what's missing, what's inconsistent, and what the team should fix first. Design only; no security or architecture notes.

Build: `com.dsoft.aradhanajewellerspalghar v1.0` Device: **Redmi Pad 2**, both apps side by side **3 Sep 2026**

The one-line verdict

The alpha is currently a brochure, not a shop. Its home screen contains no products, no prices and no live rate — only banners. There is no Shop or Categories entry in the bottom navigation or in the 16-item side menu, no cart anywhere in the app, and no search on the home screen.

Joyalukkas, by contrast, opens on jewellery, puts Search and Bag in the header, gives Category its own nav tab, and offers a four-way browse taxonomy (category → style → price → metal & stone). **The gap isn't visual polish — it's that the shopping journey hasn't been built yet.**

0	0	3×	6
Products visible anywhere in the alpha	Ways to reach a shop/category list from the nav or menu	Same banner repeated on one home screen	Different backdrops across 8 category thumbnails

I Side by side

Same device, same session, both apps opened fresh.

ELEMENT	ARADHANA ALPHA	JOYALUKKAS

Home screen content	Banners only — no product, no price, no rate data	Full-bleed product hero (ring worn on a hand) + category circles
Live gold rate on home	None. Rate is a <i>banner image</i> , not data	Not on home, but Gold Scheme is a nav tab; rate reachable in one tap
Search	Not on home. Only appears inside a category screen	Magnifier in header, on every screen
Cart / Bag	Absent from the entire app	Bag icon in header, persistent
Bottom navigation	Today's Rate · Wallet · Gold SIP · My Txn · Contact (<i>no Home, no Shop, no Cart, no Account</i>)	Home · Price Scanner · Category · Gold Scheme · Account
Browse taxonomy	8 flat category circles, nothing else	Metal tiles → accordion categories → Shop by Style → Shop by Price → Shop by Metal & Stone
Shop by budget	None	Six price bands, ₹10k → ₹1L+
Category thumbnails	Six different backdrops (white, cream, silver, black, maroon)	One peach circle + orange ring, uniform across all
Side menu	16 items — none is Shop, Categories or Search	Browse lives in the nav, not buried in a menu
Guest browsing	Skip on login ✓	Browsable immediately ✓

II Fix first

These block the app from functioning as a jewellery shop at all. Everything else is secondary to these four.

There is no way to shop

P0 · NAVIGATION

The bottom navigation is Today's Rate · Wallet · Gold SIP · My Txn · Contact. The side menu has 16 entries — My Profile, Digi Gold, Gold Schemes, E-Gift Cards, Book My Gold, Transactions, My Offers, Jewellery Rate Calculator, Bangle Sizer, Ring Sizer, My Orders, Custom Order, Store Locator, Refer a friend, and two policies. **None of them is Shop, Categories, Collections or Search.** The only route to jewellery is the eight circles on the home screen.

DO THIS

Add **Shop** as a bottom-nav tab (replacing My Txn, which belongs in Profile). Add a persistent **Search** and **Bag** to the header on every screen, as Joyalukkas does. The nav should read: Home · Shop · Gold+ · Bag · Account.

The home screen sells nothing

PO · HOME

Scrolling the full home screen produces: category circles, then eight consecutive full-width banners. No product card, no price, no rate figure. At least five separate CTAs ("VIEW LIVE RATES", "CHECK TODAY'S RATE", the Live Metal Rates card, the Todays Rate tab, and a rate banner) all lead to the same place.

DO THIS

Cut to **one** hero banner. Below it put what a jewellery shopper actually came for: today's gold and silver rate as *live text*, then a product rail ("New Arrivals"), then the Gold+ tiles. One CTA per destination.

Section headings don't match what's under them

PO · CONTENT

Three headings are wrong on a single screen:

- **SHOP BY CATEGORY** → followed by gold-rate banners, no categories
- **VIEW ALL CATEGORIES OUR EXCLUSIVE BRANDS** → followed by an "Our Legacy" brand banner. This is also two headings run together with no punctuation.
- **CUSTOMISE JEWELLERY AT OUR STORE** → followed by the same "A Relationship Beyond Jewellery" banner shown directly above it

"Rates Without the Boring Part" and "A Relationship Beyond Jewellery" each appear three times on one scroll.

DO THIS

Every heading must own the block beneath it. De-duplicate the banner set — one banner per message. Give headings a real hierarchy (left-aligned, sentence case, one weight for section titles) instead of identical centred grey caps.

Cartoon clipart is undercutting the premium positioning

PO · BRAND

The four Gold+ tiles — Digi Gold, Gold SIP, Gift Card, Book My Gold — use stock cartoon illustrations: a pink piggy bank, a gift box with a bow, a stack of coins, gold bars with sparkles. They sit directly beneath premium jewellery photography and the "A Legacy of Trust Since 1995" line. The tonal clash is the single biggest thing making the app feel cheap.

DO THIS

Replace all four with one consistent icon set — fine gold line icons on the navy tile, or real photography (a gold coin, a passbook, a gift envelope). No cartoons anywhere in a jewellery app.

III Fix next

Consistency and craft issues — individually small, collectively the difference between "template" and "considered".

Category thumbnails were shot on six different backgrounds

P1 • IMAGERY

Across the eight circles: Ladies RING on white, Gold Mangalsutra on cream, Diamond Necklace on grey silk, Gold Bracelet on white, Gold bangles on black, Gold Necklace on maroon, Gents Ring on white. Lined up in a row on the category screen the mismatch is unmissable. Joyalukkas uses one soft-peach circle with an orange ring for every single category.

DO THIS

Re-cut all category thumbnails onto one background — ideally a soft ivory or the brand navy — with the piece centred at a consistent scale. This is a half-day of retouching and it will lift the home screen more than any other single change.

The "More" button dominates the category grid

P1 • HIERARCHY

In a grid of seven photographic circles, the eighth slot is a solid navy disc reading "More" — making the least important element the most visually dominant on the screen.

DO THIS

Make it a quiet outlined circle with a chevron, or drop it entirely once Shop exists in the nav.

Label casing is inconsistent

P1 · COPY

"Ladies RING", "Gold bangles", "Gold Mangalsutra", "Gents Ring", "Diamond Necklace" — three different casing conventions in one row.

DO THIS

Title Case everywhere: Ladies Ring, Gold Bangles, Gold Mangalsutra, Gents Ring.

Copy tone contradicts itself

P1 · VOICE

"Rates Without the Boring Part" sits a few hundred pixels from "A Legacy of Trust Since 1995" and "Trusted guidance from our family to yours." A 30-year family jeweller shouldn't sound like a fintech startup.

DO THIS

Pick one voice — warm, plain, confident — and rewrite the banner set to match. "Today's rates, updated live" says the same thing without the wink.

Banner imagery is repetitive and reads as synthetic

P1 · IMAGERY

The same model in the same blue saree appears in four consecutive banners in near-identical poses, twice pointing at a phone whose screen is a blank blue rectangle. Joyalukkas' hero is a close crop of an actual ring on a hand — the product is the hero, not a presenter.

DO THIS

Lead with the jewellery, shot close. If presenter imagery is kept, use it once, and never with a blank device screen — composite the actual app UI into it.

No way to shop by budget

P1 · BROWSE

Joyalukkas offers six price bands (Under ₹10,000 through Above ₹1 L) plus Shop by Style and Shop by Metal & Stone. Budget is the first filter most gold buyers apply, and the alpha has no filtering at all.

DO THIS

Add Shop by Price bands and Shop by Style to the category screen before launch. These are browse entry points, not just filters.

The empty state is bare

P1 · STATES

Every one of the seven categories currently returns "No product available in selected category." — centred grey text on white, with no illustration, no explanation and no alternative action. Since the catalogue is empty in this build, this is the screen the team will see most.

DO THIS

Design a proper empty state: a light line illustration, a warmer line ("New pieces are being added — meanwhile, see our bestsellers"), and a button to another category or the store locator.

IV Then polish

Your best features are buried

P2 · OPPORTUNITY

Bangle Sizer, Ring Sizer, Jewellery Rate Calculator and Custom Order are all hidden in the side menu. Tanishq markets its ring-size calculator as a headline feature on its onboarding carousel. These are genuine differentiators and no customer will find them where they currently sit.

DO THIS

Surface Ring Sizer, Bangle Sizer and the Rate Calculator as a "Tools" row on the home screen or inside Shop.

The wordmark changes between splash and header

P2 · BRAND

The splash uses the real logo — an elegant gold serif lockup with the arched "A". The app header then renders "ARADHANA JEWELLERS" in a heavy geometric sans that shares none of its character.

DO THIS

Use the actual logo asset in the header, or a typeface that matches the lockup.

Nav active-state is wrong

P2 · NAVIGATION

"Today's Rate" renders as the selected tab while the home screen is showing, and tapping it doesn't navigate anywhere.

DO THIS

Introduce a real Home tab and let the selected state follow the actual screen.

Tablet landscape isn't handled

P2 · LAYOUT

The app is portrait-locked. On a tablet held in landscape it letterboxes into a narrow centre strip with dead navy bars either side. On the Pad 2 Pro's own home screen the category row also broke, leaving a single circle floating in empty space.

DO THIS

Either support a proper landscape/tablet layout (two-column grid), or lock to portrait cleanly with a branded backdrop rather than raw letterboxing.

Login screen composition is top-heavy

P2 · LAYOUT

Logo, field and buttons occupy the top 45%; the lower half is empty. The background jewellery photograph is washed out to near-invisibility.

DO THIS

Either centre the form block vertically, or let the background photograph carry real contrast so the empty half is doing work.

V What's working – keep it

Genuine strengths in the alpha

- **Skip on login.** Guest browsing is available immediately — this matches every benchmark and beats Tanishq, which hard-walls users behind OTP.

- **The splash logo lockup is genuinely premium** — gold arched "A" on navy with soft particles. It's the strongest brand moment in the app; the rest should live up to it.
- **The financial suite is complete.** Digi Gold, Gold SIP, Book My Gold and E-Gift Cards together match what the whole dsoft competitor family offers, and beats GIVA. The concept is right — only the presentation needs work.
- **The utility set is a real differentiator** — Bangle Sizer, Ring Sizer, Rate Calculator, Custom Order. No competitor in the 14-app review had all four.
- **Category strip with active highlight** on the listing screen is a good, standard pattern — keep it.
- **Navy and gold palette** is on-brand and correctly applied. Colour is not the problem.

VI Suggested order of work

If the team only does the first four, the app stops being a brochure and starts being a shop.

01	Add Shop to the bottom nav; add Search + Bag to the header Nav becomes Home · Shop · Gold+ · Bag · Account. Move My Txn into Account.
02	Rebuild the home screen around product and rate One hero banner, live gold/silver rate as text, a New Arrivals product rail, then the Gold+ tiles.
03	De-duplicate banners and fix every section heading One banner per message; each heading must describe the block beneath it.
04	Replace the cartoon tile icons One consistent gold line-icon set, or real photography. Highest premium-feel gain per hour spent.
05	Normalise all category thumbnails onto one background Half a day of retouching; biggest single visual improvement to the home screen.
06	Add Shop by Price and Shop by Style Budget bands are the first filter gold buyers reach for.
07	Design the empty, loading and error states

With the catalogue still empty, these are the most-seen screens in the build.

08

Fix label casing and rewrite the banner copy to one voice

Title Case throughout; drop the jokey register.

09

Surface the sizers and rate calculator

Move them out of the side menu onto Home or Shop.

10

Unify the wordmark, then handle tablet landscape

Use the real logo asset in the header; add a two-column tablet layout.